

■ Fitts's Law

■ What is it?

The closer and larger a target, the easier it is to use.

How far you need to move (like with a mouse or finger) and how big the target is will decide how easy it is to interact with it.

For example, think about how hard it is to tap the tiny “**X**” on a pop-up ad compared to the big “**Buy Now**” button in an online store.

■■ History

Paul Fitts (1954) introduced this law while studying human movement.

He discovered that the time to hit a target depends on two things:

1. **Distance** → how far you need to move
2. **Size** → how big the target is

This became a foundation in **human-computer interaction (HCI)** and is now widely applied in UX and UI design.

■ The Psychology Behind It

- The brain calculates **effort vs. reward** before moving.
- Small or distant targets feel harder and slower to reach.
- Larger and closer targets feel easy and satisfying.

That's why people abandon tasks when buttons or links are too small or far away.

■■ Why It Matters

Poor application of Fitts's Law can cause:

- Lower conversion rates
- Higher bounce rates
- More user frustration
- Poor engagement

■ How to Apply It

- **Use large buttons** → especially for critical actions.
- **Place key actions near edges/corners** → easy to reach quickly.
- **Optimize touch targets** → make buttons finger-friendly on mobile.
- **Add spacing between items** → avoid misclicks in dropdowns or menus.

■ Theory in Action

- **Spotify** uses right-click menus for quick actions, reducing mouse travel.
- **ATM keypads** use large, well-spaced buttons so anyone can enter numbers easily—even with shaky hands.

■ Final Thought

Fitts's Law shows why size and placement matter in design.

The easier it is to reach and tap a target, the smoother the user experience.

Whether it's on a website, an app, or a physical device—**make key actions big, clear, and easy to hit.**